

Green Valley Community Hospital

Billing Department

Billing and Payment Policy

Policy ID:	GVC-BIL-002	Version:	1.0
Effective Date:	1 January 2026	Review Date:	1 January 2027
Document Status:	Active	Hospital:	Green Valley Community Hospital

Purpose

This policy explains how billing works at Green Valley Community Hospital, including accepted payment methods, how billing statements are issued, and how patients can ask questions about charges or request a refund.

The policy is written for patients, family members, and hospital staff, so that everyone involved in a hospital visit understands how charges are tracked, communicated, and settled from registration through to discharge.

Scope

This policy applies to all patients receiving inpatient or outpatient services at Green Valley Community Hospital, and to family members who make payments on a patient's behalf.

It covers administrative billing matters only. Questions about the clinical reasons for a particular treatment should be directed to the treating department rather than the billing desk, since billing staff handle charges and payments rather than clinical decisions.

Policy Statement

Green Valley Community Hospital aims to keep billing simple and transparent. Patients receive clear billing information during their stay and a final bill at discharge. The billing desk is available to answer questions about charges at any point during a patient's visit.

Billing Desk and Initial Billing Information

The billing desk operates during specified administrative hours: 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday to Saturday. Patients or their family members can visit the billing desk, located near the admission area, to ask about estimated costs, request a deposit receipt, or review current charges.

Shortly after admission, the billing desk provides initial billing information, including an estimate of common charges for the type of care being provided. This estimate may change as treatment continues, and patients are encouraged to check in with the billing desk periodically during a longer stay.

Payment Methods

Green Valley Community Hospital accepts several payment methods so that patients can choose the option that is most convenient for them.

Payment Method	Notes
Cash	Accepted at the billing desk during desk hours.
Card payment	Debit and credit cards are accepted at the billing desk and at self-service kiosks.
Digital payment	Bank transfer and mobile payment options are accepted; ask the billing desk for current details.

Patients can pay their hospital bill using a card at the billing desk or at a self-service payment kiosk located in the main lobby. Card payments are processed immediately, and a receipt is issued automatically.

Deposits and Partial Payments

For planned inpatient admissions, an initial deposit may be requested at the time of registration. The deposit is applied toward the final bill at discharge. Patients who are unable to pay the full estimated deposit can discuss partial payment arrangements with the billing desk.

Partial payments made during a hospital stay are recorded against the patient's account and reflected in the next billing statement.

Billing Statements and Receipts

Patients can request a printed or digital billing statement at any time by visiting the billing desk or contacting the Administrative Services Desk. Statements list the charges recorded so far, any payments made, and the current outstanding balance.

Receipts should be retained for future reference, including for insurance claims or personal records. Digital receipts are sent automatically to the contact information provided at registration, when available.

Billing Questions and Incorrect Charges

Billing questions can be submitted to the billing desk in person, by phone during desk hours, or by email to the Administrative Services Desk. If a patient believes a charge is incorrect, they should raise the concern as soon as possible so that billing staff can review the relevant records.

- Describe the charge in question, including the date if known.
- Provide the patient reference number issued at registration.
- Billing staff will review the charge and respond within a reasonable time, usually within three working days.

Refund Requests

Refund requests require basic payment information and supporting documents, such as the original receipt and the patient reference number. Refunds are usually considered when a deposit is larger than the final bill, or when a payment was made in error.

Refund requests can be submitted at the billing desk using a simple refund request form. The billing desk will confirm receipt of the request and provide an estimated processing time.

Final Bill and Discharge Coordination

The final bill is prepared during the discharge process. Once treatment is complete and a discharge has been approved, the billing desk calculates the total charges, applies any deposits or insurance payments

already received, and presents the final amount due.

Patients are encouraged to settle the final bill before leaving the hospital. If the final bill cannot be settled immediately, the billing desk can discuss short-term payment arrangements.

Timelines for Common Billing Tasks

The table below summarizes typical timelines for common billing tasks, so patients know roughly what to expect at each stage of their visit.

Billing Task	Typical Timeline
Initial billing estimate	Provided shortly after admission
Billing statement request	Available same day at the billing desk
Response to a billing question	Within three working days
Refund processing	Usually within seven working days of an approved request
Final bill preparation	Prepared during the discharge process

Responsibilities

The Billing Department is responsible for maintaining accurate billing records, issuing statements and receipts, and responding to billing questions. Patients and family members are responsible for reviewing their billing statements and raising any concerns promptly.

Both the Billing Department and the patient share responsibility for keeping communication clear: billing staff should explain charges in plain language, and patients should ask questions whenever a charge is unclear rather than waiting until discharge.

Exceptions

In emergency cases, care is provided before billing formalities are completed. Billing information is still collected as soon as practical after the patient's condition is stable. Patients facing genuine difficulty in making an immediate payment can discuss alternative arrangements with the billing desk on a case-by-case basis.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I pay my hospital bill using a card?

A: Yes. Card payments are accepted at the billing desk and at self-service payment kiosks in the main lobby.

Q: How can a patient request a billing statement?

A: Patients can request a printed or digital billing statement at the billing desk or by contacting the Administrative Services Desk.

Q: How are refunds requested?

A: Refund requests require the original receipt and patient reference number, and can be submitted at the billing desk using a refund request form.

Q: What happens during final billing?

A: The billing desk calculates total charges, applies deposits or insurance payments already received, and presents the final amount due during the discharge process.

Q: What are the billing desk hours?

A: The billing desk operates from 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday to Saturday.

Q: What should I do if I think a charge is incorrect?

A: Contact the billing desk with the charge details and your patient reference number so staff can review the record, usually within three working days.

Contact Information

For general questions about this policy, please contact the Administrative Services Desk.

Contact Point	Details
Administrative Services Desk	+1-555-010-2400
General Email	info@greenvalleyhospital.example
Hospital Address	25 Green Valley Road, Riverside District, New Harmony
Desk Hours	Monday to Saturday, 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM